A2 - Oral Mediation 2: Learning Sequence

Good habits for a better life.

Your friend Thomas is from Wales. He has written a lot of exams at school and has not had much time to do any sport for a long time. He has also gained some weight because he has eaten fast food. He is feeling tired and is not in good shape. He is also very stressed and anxious. Now, his exams have finished, and he wants to change his eating habits and become more active. He feels a bit lost and does not know what he can do to change. He has sent a voice message to your mobile phone asking you for advice. You want to help by telling him some things that he can do to improve his health.



You have ten minutes to prepare the task. Your message to Thomas should last between 2.30 to 3 minutes. Remember that you have to give him clear and concise information. Your message has to include tips and advice to improve his health.



In oral mediation, you need to understand the texts and the images provided. When you understand all the ideas, try to explain your message in your own words.

Make sure it is clear why you are talking about the topic. Refer to the context.

Refer to the document you have been asked to read, but do not read it aloud. Use the information given in the texts.

Let's get ready!

1. Analyse the task

a. Read the task carefully and answer these questions. They will help you choose the register of the mediation task.

   a) Who will send the message?

   b) Who will receive the message?

   c) What information does Thomas need?

b. After analysing the task, choose the correct answer.

   a) I have to give Thomas the information he is asking for.

   b) In this mediation task I have to use complicated language and omit information.

   c) Oral language is more formal.

2. Analyse the information

Read the information in the poster carefully.

   a) What is the important information in the poster that your friend Thomas needs?

   b) Underline the ideas that you think can help Thomas with new healthy habits.

Let's prepare the language!

1. Discuss advantages and benefits

1. Read this text where a doctor is explaining the advantages of good habits for both the body and the mind. Underline the expressions that the doctor uses to talk about time sequences.

Nowadays we are living in a very stressful world. Every day we have to face new challenges and do a lot of activities. Studies, work, traffic jams and many other things make us feel anxious and tired. From time to time, we have to disconnect from all that. The problem is when we do not know how to do it. First of all, we have to remember that stress is a silent problem that hardly ever warns us before it is too late.

We live immersed in such chaos that we do not have time to notice the problems that are associated with stressful situations. Panic attacks, high blood pressure and lack of concentration are some of the problems that can appear if we do not learn how to take care of ourselves. In the end, we can experience a lot of changes in our body and mind that have to be treated by specialists. Learn the symptoms and treat them before it is too late. Listen to your body! If you do, your quality of life will improve. Also, take care of your mind and think positively. We need a healthy mind in a healthy body!

Other Useful Language

You should …
Don´t forget that …
The best thing you can do …
… as well as …
Both … and …
Neither … nor…

Do not use the same expressions all the time. Include these new expressions in your vocabulary and put them into practice.



2. Put the time expressions below in order from more frequent to less frequent.

never always hardly ever usually

1. _____
2. _____
3. _____
4. _____

2. Give reasons and examples

1. Answer the following questions with information from the text. Copy the evidence.

a) What consequences can a stressful life have on our health?

_____

b) Is there anything we can do to avoid health problems caused by stress?

_____

Let's mediate!

Your friend Thomas is from Wales. He has written a lot of exams at school and has not had much time to do any sport for a long time. He has also gained some weight because he has eaten fast food. He is feeling tired and is not in good shape. He is also very stressed and anxious. Now, his exams have finished, and he wants to change his eating habits and become more active. He feels a bit lost and does not know what he can do to change. He has sent a voice message to your mobile phone asking you for advice. You want to help by telling him some things that he can do to improve his health.

1. Content

Content

Look at the poster on page 1 and read the information there carefully again.
Select the information you are going to tell your friend Thomas.
You can use the following questions:

- Apart from the tips in the poster, can you think of any other good advice for Thomas?
- Does a balanced diet have benefits?

2. Language

Language

Use your own words. Simplify or paraphrase the information.

Remember to adapt your register to the task and addressee.

Vary the language you use. Look at the Other Useful Language on page 3.